

A NATURAL LAW DISCUSSION

From the Ancients to Contemporary Thought

The Crisis and Renewal of Natural Law in the Modern World

Key Themes and Challenges for Church and State

Università Europea di Roma
1–3 October 2026

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE

DATE

1-3 October 2026

VENUE

Università Europea di Roma (UER)

Via degli Aldobrandeschi, 190

00163 Roma

CO-HOSTS

Università Europea di Roma

International Catholic Jurists Forum

Lumen De Lumine Foundation

Centro Studi Livatino

Iuris Naturalis Societas

European Centre for Law and Justice

Fundacion Veritas

HOTEL AFFILIATES

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Hotel the Brand | +39 0687155244

Thursday, 1 October 2026

08:15 **Mass**

09:00 **Registration and Welcome from the Co-hosts**
Moderator: John Klink (Lumen De Lumine Foundation)

Co-hosts:
Prof. Padre Pedro Amador Barrajón Muñoz (Rettore UER)
Prof. Aniello Merone, President, Law School (UER)
Prof. Jane Adolphe, President, International Catholic Jurists Forum
Avv. Emilio Artiglieri, President, Lumen De Lumine Foundation
Prof. Diego Poole, Founding Member, Iuris Naturalis Societas
Prof. Mauro Ronco, President, Centro Studi Livatino
Avv. Grégor Puppinck, Director General, European Centre for Law and Justice
Prof. Miguel Angel López Lozano, Fundacion Veritas

10:00 **Keynote Lectio Magistralis**
Cardinal Raymond Leo Burke

11:00 *Break*

11:15 **Round Table I: The Discovery of Natural Law: From the Greeks to the Scholastics**

Moderator: Fulvio Di Blasi (Universidad del Atlántico Medio & International Catholic Jurists Forum)

Participants: J. Budziszewski (University of Texas at Austin), **A. Favaro** (Università di Verona), **Daniel B. Gallagher** (Ralston College, USA), **and Diego Poole** (Rey Juan Carlos University, Madrid & Founding Member, Iuris Naturalis Societas)

12:30 *Audience Questions*

13:30 *Lunch*

Thursday, 1 October 2026 (cont.)

Presentations: 30 min · Responses: 10 min

14:30 **<u>Panel I: Reason and Moral Knowledge</u>**
Moderator: Markus Krienke (Theological Faculty of Lugano)

"Father Knows Best: Natural Law in the Fathers, East and West." – J. Budziszewski (University of Texas at Austin)
Response: Rev. Piotr Mazurkiewicz (Cardinal Stefan Wyszynski University, Warsaw)

"Perseity and the Sapiential Grasp of the Natural Law" – Daniel B. Gallagher (Ralston College, USA)
Response: Antonio Vernacotola Gualtieri d'Ocre (Università Unidolomiti)

"Thomas Aquinas on Natural Law" – Rev. Vladimiro Caroli, OP (Lumen De Lumine Foundation)
Response: Fulvio Di Blasi (Universidad del Atlántico Medio & International Catholic Jurists Forum)

"Nature and Morality" – Paolo Pagani (Università Ca' Foscari di Venezia)
Response: Pietro Polieri (Università di Bari)

17:10 *Break*

17:30 **Round Table II: Natural Law and Legal Positivism**
Moderator: Tommaso Scandroglio (Independent Researcher)

Participants: Iain Benson (University of Notre Dame Australia), **Fulvio Di Blasi** (Universidad del Atlántico Medio & International Catholic Jurists Forum)**, Rev. Carlos José Errázuriz M.** (Pontificia Università della Santa Croce, Roma), **Markus Krienke** (Theological Faculty of Lugano), **Antonio Vernacotola Gualtieri d'Ocre** (Università Unidolomiti)**, and Aldo Rocco Vitale** (Università Europea di Roma)

19:00 *Audience Questions*

19:45 *Cocktails*

20:30 *(Organized) Dinner*

Friday, 2 October 2026

Presentations: 30 min · Responses: 10 min

08:15 **Mass**

09:00 **Panel II: Ius vs. Lex**

Moderator: Michał Gierycz (Cardinal Stefan Wyszynski University, Warsaw)

"The Re-Semanticization of Natural Law in the Personalist Horizon" – Rev. Livio Melina (Theologian & Former Dean of the Pontifical John Paul II Institute for Studies on Marriage and the Family)

Response: Diego Poole (Rey Juan Carlos University, Madrid & Founding Member, Iuris Naturalis Societa)

"Thomistic Juridical Realism and the Essence of Ius" – Rev. Carlos José Errázuriz M. (Pontificia Università della Santa Croce, Roma)

Response: Antonio Casciano (Università di Salerno)

"Natural Law, State and Authority" – Andrea Favaro (Università di Verona)

Response: Aldo Rocco Vitale (Università Europea di Roma)

11:00 *Break*

11:20 **"The Prudential Turn? Natural Law after Veritatis Splendor and Amoris Laetitia" – Diego Poole** (Rey Juan Carlos University, Madrid & Founding Member, Iuris Naturalis Societas)

Response: Markus Krienke (Theological Faculty of Lugano)

12:00 *Audience Questions*

13:00 *Lunch*

Friday, 2 October 2026 (cont.)

Presentations: 30 min · Responses: 10 min

14:00 **Panel III: Natural Law, Justice, and Bioethics**
Moderator: Andrea Favaro (Università di Verona)

"Natural Law and the School of Salamanca" – Simona Langella (Università di Genova)
Response: Rev. Carlos José Errázuriz M. (Pontificia Università della Santa Croce, Roma)

"Natural Law and End of Life" – Mauro Ronco (Università di Padova & President, Centro Studi Livatino)
Response: Carmelo Leotta (Università Europea di Roma)

"Natural Law and New Technologies" – Francesco Zini (Università di Siena)
Response: Giulia Bovassi (Università dell'Anáhuac)

16:00 *Break*

16:20 **"Anthological Foundations of Natural Law: Restoring the Primacy of the Common Good Against Political Arbitrariness" – Miguel Ángel Lopez Lozano** (Universidad del Atlántico Medio)
Response: Tommaso Scandroglio (Independent Researcher)

17:00 **Round Table III: Natural Law and Justice**
Moderator: Aldo Rocco Vitale (Università Europea di Roma)

Participants: Cristina Caja Moya (Universidad del Atlántico Medio)**, Daniele Onori** (Centro Studi Livatino)**, Pietro Polieri** (Università di Bari)**, and Aleksander Stępkowski** (Polish Supreme Court Judge & Professor of Law, University of Warsaw)

18:30 *Audience Questions*

19:15 *Cocktails*

20:00 *(Open) Dinner*

Saturday, 3 October 2026

Presentations: 30 min · Responses: 10 min

08:15 **Mass**

09:00 **<u>Panel IV: Natural Law, Human Rights, and the Global Order (Politics, Diplomacy, UN Debates)</u>**
Moderator: Miguel Ángel Lopez Lozano (Universidad del Atlántico Medio)

"Papal Magisterium and the Natural Law" – Rev. Piotr Mazurkiewicz (Cardinal Stefan Wyszynski University, Warsaw)
Response: Michał Gierycz (Cardinal Stefan Wyszynski University, Warsaw)

"The Church and the Contemporary Debate: Natural Rights and Human Rights" – Aleksander Stępkowski (Polish Supreme Court Judge & Professor of Law, University of Warsaw) **and Grégor Puppinck** (Director, European Centre for Law and Justice)
Response: Daniele Trabucco (Università Unidolomiti)

10:30 *Break*

10:45 **"Implicit and Explicit Metaphysics of Modern Law" – Iain Benson** (University of Notre Dame Australia)

Round Table IV: Natural Rights or Human Rights?

11:15

Moderator: Grégor Puppinck (Director General, European Centre for Law and Justice)

Participants: Jane Adolphe (Ave Maria School of Law, USA & President, International Catholic Jurists Forum), **Iain Benson** (University of Notre Dame Australia), **and Aleksander Stępkowski** (Polish Supreme Court Judge & Professor of Law, University of Warsaw)

Saturday, 3 October 2026

Presentations: 30 min · Responses: 10 min

12:00 **Closing Lectures**

Moderator: Aniello Merone (President of Law School, Università Europea di Roma)

"Natural Law, Reason, and Faith: the Cultural Mission of the Church" – Rev. Salvatore Vitiello (Lumen de Lumine Foundation)

"Natural Law in the Contemporary Debate" – Fulvio Di Blasi (Universidad del Atlántico Medio & International Catholic Jurists Forum)

13:00 *Lunch and Final Greetings*